

September 25th, 2026
Week 39
Volume 282, Issue 1254

QUOTE
of the
WEEK

"The time to repair the roof is when the sun is shining."

- John F. Kennedy

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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EARNINGS ROAR, SUPPLY RETREATS

Highlights:

- Tanker rates soar.

- Crude rebounds.

- Earnings win.

- Sales vanish.

Last week, constrained passage through Hormuz was the story. This week, the cost of moving through it has become the louder one. Tanker availability has tightened dramatically as Gulf flows, security concerns and disrupted alternatives compete for the same ships, with some VLCC employment reportedly exceeding USD 1 million per day. A tanker was also struck in the Strait earlier this week, injuring crew members, while reports of a possible phased U.S.-Iran arrangement to reopen Hormuz have supplied diplomacy without yet supplying normality. For owners of elderly tankers, the calculation has become unusually simple. A ship earning extraordinary money is not a recycling candidate.

Crude spent much of the week reacting to every suggestion that more Gulf supply could move. Brent fell below USD 100 as reports emerged of possible progress on Hormuz and renewed Saudi export options, before recovering toward USD 106 on Friday, while WTI traded around USD 94. The barrel has therefore eased from the panic of recent weeks without returning to anything resembling pre-conflict conditions. Oil remains expensive, routing remains complicated and tanker scarcity is translating geopolitical risk directly into freight.

Dry freight, meanwhile, strengthened again. The Baltic Dry Index reached 3,473 on Thursday, with Capesizes at 5,939, Panamaxs at 2,382 and Supramaxes at 1,782. Capesize earnings remain particularly healthy, while the geared sectors have also held comfortably above levels that would normally encourage owners toward an exit. Last week's message therefore advances rather than changes: owners were being paid to trade; this week some tanker owners are being paid exceptionally well to trade. Candidate supply has responded accordingly.

Currencies have offered recyclers little compensation. The Indian Rupee sits around 96.0 against the Dollar, Pakistan's Rupee has strengthened marginally to approximately 277.17, and Bangladesh Bank's latest reference rate is around 123.18. The Turkish Lira has moved the wrong way again, toward 49 to the Dollar. The Federal Reserve's 25 basis-point increase to a 3.75% to 4.00% range is now being absorbed rather than newly priced, leaving local steel and vessel availability as the more immediate recycling variables.

At the beaches, the contrast between physical activity and fresh supply has become sharper. Previously secured vessels continue to arrive and deliver across Chattogram, Alang and Gadani, including several Chattogram deliveries on publication day. Yet no fresh market sales are reported this week. Last week's candidate list was already struggling to replenish itself; the extraordinary tanker market has now removed another category of potential sellers from serious recycling discussion. The waterfront is working through yesterday's purchases. Today's owners are finding better employment elsewhere. This continues directly from Week 38, when GMS noted that physical activity was outpacing fresh transactions and owners were still being paid to trade rather than recycle.

Pakistan therefore retains the lead, although the frantic August premium has disappeared. Bangladesh has steadily rebuilt appetite and now needs ships more than another reason to buy them. India remains well behind on conventional units but continues to make specialist and compliance-sensitive tonnage pay. Above all three sits an increasingly stubborn owner. Tankers are earning extraordinary money, dry ships are earning good money, and second-hand alternatives remain open. The breakers have the appetite. The trading market has the ships.

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GMS market rankings / pricing for week 39 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH



YARDS READY, OWNERS BUSY

Demand builds.

Demand has been creeping back into Chattogram for several weeks, and the appetite is now clearly visible. What has not returned is the steady stream of fresh candidates required to satisfy it. The approach to the fourth quarter has been largely inert from a transaction perspective, leaving end buyers hoping that the final months of 2026 and the opening of 2027 finally provide the volume needed to refill increasingly available yard capacity. That requirement carries additional weight after the considerable investment made across Bangladesh over recent years to bring facilities toward HKC standards. Buyers are ready. The difficulty remains finding owners prepared to sell into a shipping market offering considerably better alternatives.

Deliveries accelerate.

The waterfront is considerably more active than the sales sheet. Cury, 3,822 LDT, Xiang Rui, 1,304 LDT, and the 5,733 LDT bulker Ganga Hai 666 are all recorded as delivered on September 25. The anchorage has also replenished, led by the sizeable 28,773 LDT gas carrier Mutiara, which arrived September 21, and the 11,078 LDT tanker Fei on September 20. Kushiro, 1,040 LDT, arrived September 18, while NEPT, 3,060 LDT, and the 16,708 LDT tanker Forever remain earlier arrivals from September 17 and 15 respectively. Physical waterfront activity has therefore improved substantially, but these are previously secured vessels and should not be mistaken for a revival in fresh recycling sales.

Fresh supply thin.

Local steel supplied no catalyst either way, with Chattogram plate unchanged throughout the week at BDT 64,000 per ton, approximately USD 522.24 per ton. The Taka remains broadly stable around the recent 123 area to the Dollar and August inflation remains the operative reading at 8.26%. Currency and steel are orderly, so requirement rather than improving domestic fundamentals is doing most of the commercial work. Bangladesh therefore enters the next tide in a healthier operational position than the absence of deals suggests. Yards are receiving vessels, demand has rebuilt and the competitive gap has narrowed, but end users cannot recycle appetite. Chattogram has rebuilt the demand. The supply has yet to answer.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA



SPECIALISTS HOLD, STEEL SLIDES

Alang's two-market story survives another week. Conventional bulkers and tankers remain well behind Pakistan and Bangladesh, but several well-priced specialist transactions over recent weeks continue to demonstrate that India's actual recycling activity cannot be read from the standard board alone. Reefers, gas carriers, green ships, non-ferrous-rich vessels and compliance-sensitive candidates attract a distinctly different buying response, allowing Alang to remain active even when ordinary steel tonnage is difficult to compete for. The European compliance story remains supportive as well, with industry backing continuing behind the proposed addition of two Indian recycling facilities to the European List, although final approval remains pending.

Specialists hold.

The latest port position advances that specialist pipeline again. Frio Hellenic, the 6,520 LDT reefer carried as an arrival last week, is now recorded as delivered on September 19, while the 8,110 LDT bulker Novaya Zemlya remains an arrival from September 16. There are no fresh market sales reported this week, but that should not be confused with inactivity. Alang continues to process specialist and desired tonnage secured during the recent run, reinforcing the distinction between India's standard competitive position and the considerably stronger levels that can be achieved for ships carrying additional non-ferrous, compliance or specialist value.

Plate retreats.

Steel, however, moved firmly against recyclers. Alang plate opened at INR 42,200 per ton, briefly reached INR 42,500, then weakened progressively through INR 41,700, INR 41,300, INR 40,700 and INR 40,100 before closing September 25 at INR 40,000. The supplied Dollar equivalent fell from approximately USD 440.13 to USD 417.10 per ton, despite briefly reaching USD 443.26 early in the period. With the Rupee around 96.0 against the Dollar and August CPI at 4.82%, there is little macro support to offset that steel decline. India therefore remains third for an ordinary steel ship, and this week's plate correction does nothing to narrow the handicap. Conventional pricing says third. Specialist tonnage continues to tell another story.

Standard gap remains.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN



TOP SPOT, COOLER HEADS

Lead retained.

Gadani remains the highest placed sub-continent market for another week, although today's market bears little resemblance to the extraordinary buying run of August. Several tanker transactions were then concluded comfortably above USD 550/LDT as pent-up requirement and candidate scarcity collided. That immediate urgency has now been partly satisfied and today's board reflects normalisation rather than disappearing demand. No fresh market sales are reported this week, but Pakistan remains willing to compete when the right candidate appears. It is simply no longer bidding as though every vessel is the last one available.

Steel steadies.

The waterfront supports that interpretation. Maria, 6,141 LDT, is now recorded as delivered on September 19, while the 11,060 LDT tanker Yue remains an arrival from September 16 and the 5,688 LDT bulker Lina F from September 1. Previously secured tonnage has therefore reached and begun feeding Gadani, while the replacement sales pipeline remains thin. This is precisely why the August spike has cooled. Some immediate yard requirement has been satisfied, but scarcity upstream remains severe enough to prevent the adjustment from developing into genuine market weakness.

HKC work advances.

Local steel has also stabilised after the correction recorded previously. Pakistan plate remained unchanged throughout the supplied period at PKR 195,000 per ton, approximately USD 696.06 per ton, while the Rupee continues to trade around the 277 area against the Dollar and the SBP policy rate remains 11.5%. Steel is no longer falling, currency remains supportive and the principal missing variable is the vessel itself. At the same time, HKC approvals and infrastructure upgrades continue to advance in a market that has historically lagged its neighbours on green standards and yard development. Pakistan therefore keeps the lead without returning to August's excesses. The demand remains. What Gadani lacks is the one commodity every hungry recycling market currently shares: a willing owner.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

AUTUMN BID, LIRA DRAGS



Aliaga's modest post-summer improvement has paused at its new level. GMS indications remain unchanged from Week 38 at USD 300/LDT for dry bulk, USD 310 to 315/LDT for tankers and USD 325 to 330/LDT for containers. Seasonal appetite remains visible, but there is no fresh commercial reason this week to lift the board again. This remains an improvement within Turkey's own recycling market rather than any attempt to compete directly with Pakistan, Bangladesh or India on conventional pricing.

Board unchanged.

The macro backdrop remains considerably less helpful. The Turkish Lira continues to weaken around the 49 to the Dollar area, while official August CPI remains at 31.51% and the TCMB policy rate at 37%. Elevated energy prices and continued currency depreciation restrict Dollar-denominated purchasing power even as recyclers show somewhat better post-summer appetite. The higher September board has therefore held despite, rather than because of, the currency environment.

Lira weakens.

Aliaga consequently remains dependent on geography, specialist vessels, European regulatory access and Basel-compliant trades rather than straightforward sub-continent competition. The proposed European List additions in India remain relevant to that longer-term niche, but they are still pending and have not altered the current hierarchy. Turkey's board has found a higher autumn level. For now, it appears comfortable staying there.

Niche remains.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 39 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / Vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	Steady	510 / LDT	530 / LDT	540 / LDT
2	Bangladesh	Improving	500 / LDT	520 / LDT	530 / LDT
3	India	Steady	465 / LDT	485 / LDT	495 / LDT
4	Turkey	Steady	300 / LDT	310-315 / LDT	325-330 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- 69.16 million tonnes of *steel recovered through ship recycling at Alang is just over twice Germany's entire 2025 crude-steel production of 34.1 million tonnes.*
- 44.4 billion kWh of *energy estimated to have been saved through ship recycling at Alang is equivalent to around 97% of Hong Kong's entire electricity consumption in 2025.*
- 276 million cubic yards of *landfill space saved through ship recycling at Alang equals roughly 211 million cubic metres, about 82% of the 258.8 million cubic metres dredged for the New Suez Canal.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
October 02 - Mahatma Gandhi's Birthday	September 25 – October 03 October 08 – October 15

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	DELIVERY TIDES
20–21 October 2026 – Durga Puja	September 26 – September 29 October 09 – October 12

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	TURKEY
November 09 – Allama Iqbal Day	28–29 October 2026 – Republic Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of September 25, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Frio Hellenic	6,520	Reefer	<i>Delivered September 19</i>
2	Novaya Zemlya	8,110	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 16

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of September 25, 2026

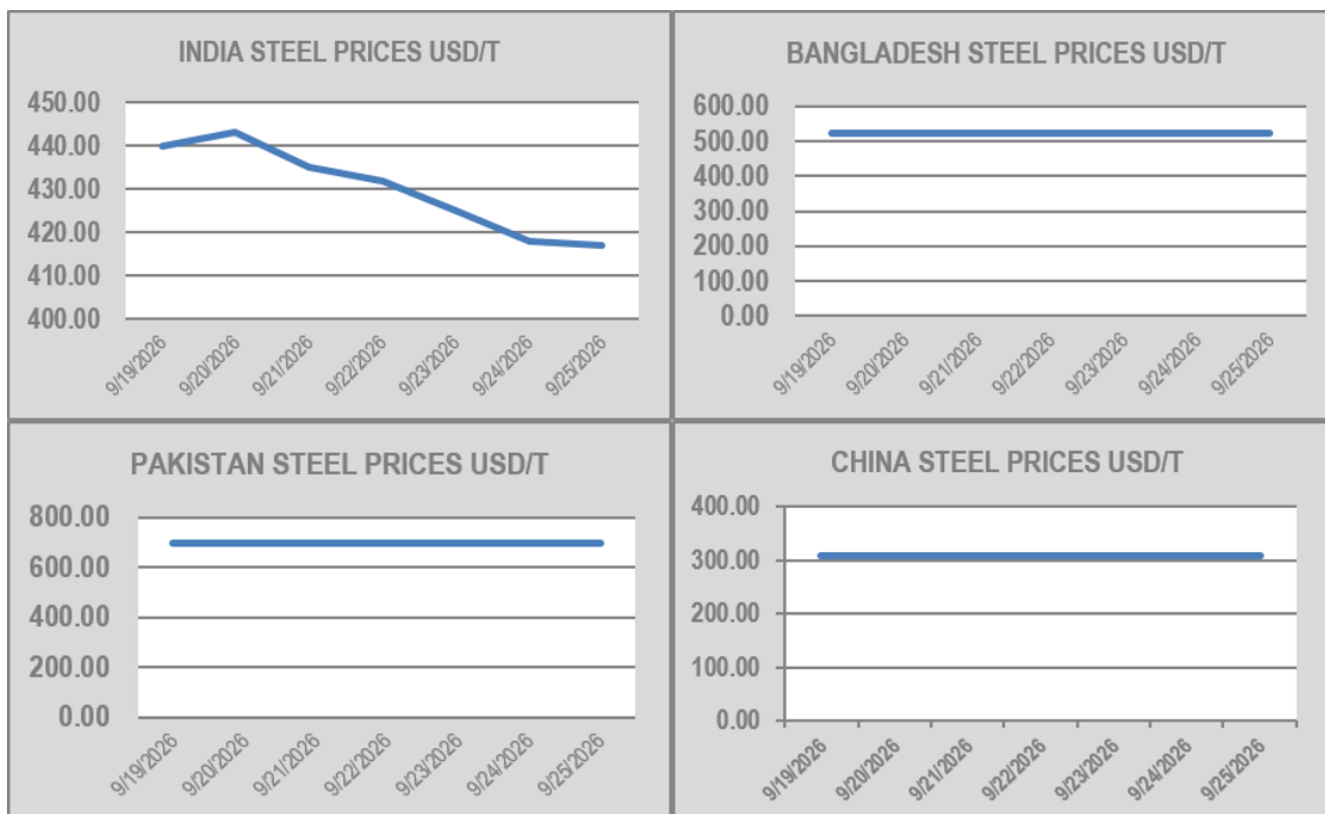
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Cury	3,822	Refrigerated Cargo	<i>Delivered September 25</i>
2	Xiang Rui	1,304	Refrigerated Cargo	<i>Delivered September 25</i>
3	Ganga Hai 666	5,733	Bulk Carrier	<i>Delivered September 25</i>
4	Mutiara	28,773	Gas Carrier	Arrived September 21
5	Fei	11,078	Tanker	Arrived September 20
6	Kushiro	1,040	General Cargo	Arrived September 18
7	NEPT	3,060	Refrigerated Cargo	Arrived September 17
8	Forever	16,708	Tanker	Arrived September 15

GADANI - Port Position as of September 25, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Maria	6,141	Bulk Carrier	<i>Delivered September 19</i>
2	Yue	11,060	Tanker	Arrived September 16
3	Lina F	5,688	Bulk Carrier	Arrived September 01

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DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
9/19/2026	440.13	42,200.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/20/2026	443.26	42,500.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/21/2026	435.24	41,700.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/22/2026	432.05	41,300.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/23/2026	425.11	40,700.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/24/2026	417.88	40,100.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46
9/25/2026	417.10	40,000.00	696.06	195,000.00	522.24	64,000.00	309.46



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